

Hassan Sayed

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Center for Global Development, 2055 L St NW Washington, D.C. 20036

Placement Director	Gianluca Violante	violante@princeton.edu	609-258-4003
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Statement

I am a microeconomist who studies applications of economic theory to organizations, innovation, and political economy. I also hold public policy experience designing and implementing funding mechanisms that accelerate innovation in climate and public health.

Employment and Education

Postdoctoral Scholar, [Market Shaping Accelerator](#) 2025-

- Initiative of Center for Global Development, Dartmouth College, and University of Chicago; researched role of market shaping in stimulating innovation under Prof. Chris Snyder.
- Designed “pull funding” mechanisms to incentivize generic drug repurposing and development of low-cost chlorine sensors, and engaged with policymakers on implementation.

PhD in Economics, Princeton University 2019-25

- Advisors: Pietro Ortoleva, Leah Boustan.
- Fields: Economic Theory, Political Economy.
- Affiliations: Research Program in Political Economy, Economic Theory Center.

BA in Economics, Mathematics, MMSS, Northwestern University 2015-19

References

Letter Writers, Economics Job Market

Pietro Ortoleva	Christopher Snyder	Faruk Gul
Department of Economics	Department of Economics	Department of Economics
Princeton University	Dartmouth College	Princeton University
pietro.ortoleva@princeton.edu	christopher.snyder@dartmouth.edu	fgul@princeton.edu

Additional References

Leah Boustan	Gleason Judd	Leah Rosenzweig
Department of Economics	Department of Politics	Market Shaping Accelerator
Yale University	Princeton University	Center for Global Development
leah.boustan@yale.edu	gleason.judd@princeton.edu	lrosenzweig@cgdev.org

[“Communicating with Models and Data.”](#)

Many real-world decisions rely on external data collection and modeling: consultants provide clients scenarios, fund managers present models of asset returns, and AI chatbots offer recommendations based on internal data. I study how model simplification in these settings distorts not just how data are interpreted but also which data are collected. A sender collects data and estimates a model that helps a receiver make a choice. The sender’s model is simple in that it artificially restricts the curvature of the relationship between choices and outcomes: a “naive” model understates curvature and neglects tradeoffs between costs and benefits, while a “cautious” model overstates curvature and exaggerates them. I show that estimating simple models creates strategic incentives to collect data poorly suited to the receiver’s decision. Senders who estimate naive models sample data about an excessively large range of choices, while those who estimate cautious models sample locally around a single extreme choice. With multiple variables, senders sample data that maximize collinearity across variables. These distortions make model simplicity strategically valuable: senders who estimate accurate models benefit when receivers misperceive their models as naive or cautious. In equilibrium, accurate senders surround themselves with simple senders who polarize into two groups: those who estimate maximally naive and maximally cautious models. In the limit, these correspond to linear regressions and “worst-case scenario” models, respectively.

Publications

1. [“Learning Traps.”](#) June 2026. **Forthcoming, American Journal of Political Science.**
2. [“Transatlantic Technologies: The Role of ICT in the Evolution of U.S. and European Productivity Growth.”](#) With Robert J. Gordon. *International Productivity Monitor* No. 38, Spring 2020.
3. [“The Industry Anatomy of the Transatlantic Productivity Growth Slowdown: Europe Chasing the American Frontier.”](#) With Robert J. Gordon. *International Productivity Monitor* No. 37, Fall 2019.

Working Papers

1. [“Optimal Push and Pull Funding for Innovation.”](#) With Chris Snyder. September 2026.
2. [“Persuasion with Partisanship: The Informational Content of Policymaking with Application to US Governors.”](#) June 2026. **Under review.**
3. [“Misconduct in Organizations.”](#) With Kim Sarnoff. June 2026. **Under review**
4. [“The Twin Puzzles of U.S. Productivity Growth Dynamics: A New Interpretation.”](#) With Robert J. Gordon. November 2025. NBER WP 30267, CEPR DP19569.

Selected Work in Progress

1. “Valence and Candidate Differentiation in Elections.” Slides available upon request.
2. “Model-Based Inference: An Experimental Approach.” With Kim Sarnoff.

3. "Evaluating Pull Funding: Evidence from Sensors for In-Line Chlorination."

Policy and Public Writing

1. "Generic Drug Repurposing Incentive Program Proposal." With Chris Snyder, Akhil Bansal, and Sarrin Chethik. Submitted to FDA RFI: Drug Repurposing for Unmet Medical Needs, July 2026.
2. "Transatlantic technologies: Why did the ICT revolution fail to boost European productivity growth?" With Robert J. Gordon. *VoxEU*, August 2020.
3. "The industry anatomy of the transatlantic productivity growth slowdown: Similarities outweigh the differences." With Robert J. Gordon. *VoxEU*, August 2019.

Teaching

Princeton	SPI 511b: Microeconomic Analysis for Policymakers (TA, Fall 2024)
Northwestern	MATH 220: Single-Variable Calculus (TA: Fall 2016) MATH 224: Single-Variable Integral Calculus (TA: Winter 2017, Fall 2017) MATH 230: Multivariable Calculus (TA: Spring 2018, Winter 2019)

Fellowships, Grants, and Honors

Alfred P. Sloan Foundation Amount: \$966,417 (part of grant 2025-25183 to Chris Snyder, Dartmouth College)	2025-27
National Science Foundation Graduate Research Fellowship Amount: \$102,000	2019-24
Research Program in Political Economy Grant, Princeton Amount: \$2,000	2024
William S. Dietrich II Economic Theory Center Research Grant Amount: \$3,900 ($\times$ 3 years)	2022-24
Princeton University Graduate Fellowship	2019-21
Frederick S. Deibler Award for Distinguished Honors Thesis, Northwestern	2019
Interdisciplinary Honors, Northwestern	2019
Phi Beta Kappa, Northwestern	2019

Other Research Experience

Research Assistant, Prof. Roland Bénabou (Princeton)	2022
Research Assistant, Prof. Robert J. Gordon (Northwestern)	2017-19

Professional Activities

Presentations

- 2027** North American Winter Meeting of the Econometric Society (Sched.)
- 2026** Midwest Theory Conference (Sched.), Center for Global Development, Stony Brook Game Theory, Midwest Political Science Association, Dartmouth College, International Industrial Organization Conference
- 2025** European Winter Meeting of the Econometric Society, Stony Brook Game Theory, Princeton Microeconomic Theory, Princeton Political Economy
- 2024** Princeton Industrial Relations Seminar, Princeton Microeconomic Theory, Princeton Political Economy
- 2023** North American Summer Meeting of the Econometric Society, Princeton Microeconomic Theory, Princeton Political Economy
- 2022** Association for Comparative Economic Studies, Princeton Microeconomic Theory, Princeton Political Economy, Young Economist Symposium
- 2021** Princeton Microeconomic Theory

Referee Services

American Economic Review

Skills and Activities

- Languages** English, Urdu; MATLAB, Python, STATA
- Citizenship** United States
- Activities** Princeton Lawrence Apartments Committee (Secretary 2021-22, President 2022-24); Adobe Creative Suite; Professional Photography

Last updated: October 2026